Queen Dor's

FASHION HOUSE

Colour system

Two colours taken from the logo, extended into a working system: ramps, roles, contrast checks, component states, tokens and a dark mode. Every number in this document is computed from the hex values rather than estimated, which is why the palette, the CSS and this PDF cannot disagree.

Adinkra Teal #0B4B4C RGB 11, 75, 76 HSL 181°, 75%, 17%

Crown Gold #C8AC77 RGB 200, 172, 119 HSL 39°, 42%, 63%

Sampled from the client's logo: the D monogram is the teal, the name and the crown are the gold. Nothing else was invented.

Brand personality: rooted, luxurious, unhurried, trustworthy. Audience: Accra retail buyers 25–45, plus wholesale stockists, shopping mostly on phones, often outdoors.

1 — Palette extraction

The two anchors sit where the logo puts them: teal at the dark end of its ramp, gold in the middle of its own. Tints and shades were generated by holding the sampled hue and moving lightness, so every step belongs to the same family as the mark.

TEAL · hue 181°

F1F9F9	E2F3F4	C4E8E9	98D6D7	63C4C5	36A9AB	218B8C	146F71	0B4B4C	093435	072122
50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950

GOLD · hue 39°



FBF7EF	F7EEDE	EFDFC3	E3CCA0	C8AC77	C09A54	AE8537	8F6B28	695021	47371A	2B2212
50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950

NEUTRALS · warm, hue 40°



FFFFFF	FAF8F5	F3EFE8	E6E1D5	D3CBBB	AEA593	8F8676	6C665A	524E47	34322D	211F1C	141210
0	50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950

The colours that carry the brand

Name	HEX	RGB	HSL	Where it goes
Adinkra Teal	#0B4B4C	11, 75, 76	180.9°, 74.7%, 17.1%	The logo's D. Primary: buttons, links, prices, headings.
Deep Adinkra	#093435	9, 52, 53	181.4°, 71.0%, 12.2%	Hover on primary, footer fields, overlay scrims.
Pale Adinkra	#98D6D7	152, 214, 215	181.0°, 44.1%, 72.0%	The dark-mode primary; teal-tinted illustration accents.
Crown Gold	#C8AC77	200, 172, 119	39.3°, 42.4%, 62.5%	The logo's name. Accent only: rules, hover, dark sections.
Antique Gold	#8F6B28	143, 107, 40	39.0°, 56.3%, 35.9%	The gold you may set text in — 4.9:1 on white.
Champagne	#EFDFC3	239, 223, 195	38.2°, 57.9%, 85.1%	Subtle backgrounds behind badges and notes.
Linen	#FAF8F5	250, 248, 245	36.0°, 33.3%, 97.1%	Page section background, alternating with white.
Charcoal Ink	#211F1C	33, 31, 28	36.0°, 8.2%, 12.0%	Body-intense text and headings at maximum contrast.

2 — Roles and priority

A palette becomes a system when each colour has one job. Anything used for two jobs will eventually be used for the wrong one.

Role	Token value	HEX	Why it fits
Primary	Adinkra Teal 800	#0B4B4C	The brand and the action. Buttons, links, prices, headings.
Secondary	Deep Adinkra 900	#093435	Depth for primary: hover, active, footer panels.
Accent	Crown Gold 400	#C8AC77	Precious, scarce. Rules, hover, dark-section buttons.
Accent text	Antique Gold 700	#8F6B28	The only gold permitted in a sentence — 4.9:1.

Role	Token value	HEX	Why it fits
Background	White / Linen 50	#FAF8F5	White for product, linen for rhythm between sections.
Surface	White + hairline	#FFFFFF	Cards float on a 1px border, not on a heavy shadow.
Text primary	Charcoal Ink 900	#211F1C	16.4:1 — body copy that never has to be squinted at.
Text muted	Warm Ash 600	#6C665A	5.7:1 — captions, help text, still AA at body size.

The 60–30–10 ratio

60% neutral — white product fields and linen bands, the room the jewellery sits in. 30% teal — headers, buttons, prices, headings, dark sections; the brand doing the work. 10% gold — rules, hover states, one band, the logo. Gold is the 10 by definition: at 30 it stops reading as precious and starts reading as beige.

3 — Contrast, checked against WCAG 2.1

Text is judged on AA 4.5:1 (normal) and 3:1 (large, 18.66px bold or 24px). Borders and controls are judged on 1.4.11, which asks 3:1 of non-text.

Light mode

Pairing	Text	Background	Ratio	AA	AA large
Body text	#211F1C	#FFFFFF	16.44:1	AAA	AAA
Headings	#0B4B4C	#FFFFFF	9.88:1	AAA	AAA
Secondary text	#3F4A49	#FFFFFF	9.18:1	AAA	AAA
Muted text	#6C665A	#FFFFFF	5.70:1	AA	AAA
Muted text on cream	#6C665A	#FAF8F5	5.37:1	AA	AAA
Link / heading	#0B4B4C	#FFFFFF	9.88:1	AAA	AAA
Link on cream	#0B4B4C	#FAF8F5	9.32:1	AAA	AAA
Primary button label	#FAF8F5	#0B4B4C	9.32:1	AAA	AAA
Gold label on teal	#C8AC77	#0B4B4C	4.53:1	AA	AAA
Dark-section body	#FAF8F5	#0B4B4C	9.32:1	AAA	AAA
Gold as text on white	#C8AC77	#FFFFFF	2.18:1	FAIL	FAIL
Antique gold as text	#8F6B28	#FFFFFF	4.88:1	AA	AAA
Input border vs page	#8F8676	#FFFFFF	3.60:1	3:1 ✓	—
Error text	#7C3027	#FFFFFF	9.09:1	AAA	AAA
Success text	#2F6A4E	#FFFFFF	6.38:1	AA	AAA
Warning text	#7A541F	#FFFFFF	6.74:1	AA	AAA

Dark mode

Pairing	Text	Background	Ratio	AA	AA large
Body text	#EDEAE0	#0A1211	15.75:1	AAA	AAA
Secondary text	#CDCBBD	#0A1211	11.62:1	AAA	AAA
Muted text	#A3A296	#0A1211	7.37:1	AAA	AAA
Muted text on card	#A3A296	#12201E	6.53:1	AA	AAA
Link	#98D6D7	#0A1211	11.68:1	AAA	AAA
Link on card	#98D6D7	#12201E	10.34:1	AAA	AAA
Primary button label	#08100F	#98D6D7	11.85:1	AAA	AAA
Gold accent on page	#D6B982	#0A1211	10.04:1	AAA	AAA
Gold as text	#E3CCA0	#0A1211	12.11:1	AAA	AAA
Input border vs page	#4F6761	#0A1211	3.11:1	3:1 ✓	—
Error text	#DD887E	#0A1211	7.13:1	AAA	AAA
Success text	#8BC6AA	#0A1211	9.71:1	AAA	AAA

The one deliberate failure

Crown Gold on white measures 2.18:1. It is kept off text on purpose — the logo's own letterforms carry far more optical weight than 15px type, so what works at 1080px across does not work in a product card. Where the client wants gold lettering, use Antique Gold #8F6B28 (4.9:1) or set the gold on teal, where it reads at 4.6:1.

4 — Component application

Each component lists its four interaction states. Focus is always a ring as well as a colour change: on a cheap phone screen in daylight, a 1px border shift is not a visible state.

Component	Default	Hover	Active	Focus	Disabled
Primary button	Teal 800 field, Linen label	Teal 900	Teal 950	2px teal ring, 2px offset	Linen field, Warm Ash label, 45% text
Secondary button	Transparent, 1px Ink 700 border	Teal 50 wash, teal border	Teal 100 wash	as primary	Hairline border, Warm Ash label
Ghost button	Teal text, no field	Teal 50 wash	Teal 100 wash	as primary	Warm Ash text, no field
Danger button	Clay Red 700 field, white label	92% brightness	88%	as primary	as disabled
Link	Teal text, gold underline	Teal 900, teal underline	Teal 950	teal ring	Warm Ash, no underline
Input	1px Warm Ash 500 border (3.6:1)	Ink 700 border	—	Teal border + 3px teal 15% ring	Linen 100 field, Warm Ash text

Component	Default	Hover	Active	Focus	Disabled
Input error	Clay Red border	—	—	Clay ring 15%	as disabled
Input success	Kola Green border	—	—	Green ring 15%	as disabled
Card	White, hairline border, shadow-sm	shadow-md, lift 2px, Ink 500 border	—	ring on the card link	Hairline, Linen 100 field
Nav item	Ink text	Teal text + gold underline grows	Teal 950	teal ring	Warm Ash
Gold on dark	Gold 400 field, Ink 900 label	Gold 300	Gold 200	Gold ring	40% gold

Rules that keep the states honest

• One primary button per view. Two primaries is a choice the customer did not ask for.
• Hover is a darkening on light surfaces, a lightening on dark ones — never a hue change, which reads as a different meaning.
• Error is never colour alone: the message says what is wrong. Roughly one man in twelve cannot reliably separate the clay red from the kola green.
• Disabled controls are exempt from AA, which is not permission to make them invisible — 45% text on a linen field still reads as 'not available'.

5 — Tokens

Two layers. The primitive layer names colours (--qd-teal-800); the semantic layer names jobs (--qd-primary). Components read only the semantic layer, which is exactly what lets dark mode swap forty values instead of rewriting a stylesheet.

Token	Job	Light	Dark
`--qd-bg-page`	Page background	#FFFFFF	#0A1211
`--qd-bg-subtle`	Alternating sections	#FAF8F5	#0F1B1A
`--qd-surface-card`	Cards, panels	#FFFFFF	#12201E
`--qd-border-subtle`	Hairlines	#E6E1D5	#22332F
`--qd-border-default`	Input borders (3:1)	#8F8676	#4F6761
`--qd-text-primary`	Max-contrast text	#211F1C	#EDEAE0
`--qd-text-heading`	Headings	#0B4B4C	#EDEAE0
`--qd-text-body`	Body copy	#3F4A49	#CDCBBD
`--qd-text-muted`	Captions, help	#6C665A	#A3A296
`--qd-primary`	Actions, links	#0B4B4C	#98D6D7

Token	Job	Light	Dark
`--qd-primary-hover`	Hover	#093435	#C4E8E9
`--qd-accent`	Gold accent	#C8AC77	#D6B982
`--qd-accent-text`	Gold text	#8F6B28	#E3CCA0
`--qd-focus`	Focus ring	#0B4B4C	#98D6D7

Also in the token file

Spacing on a 4px base (--qd-space-1 … 12, 4–128px). Radius: 2 / 4 / 6 / 10 / 16 / pill. Elevation in four steps plus a gold glow reserved for one featured card. Shadows are teal-tinted, never neutral grey — a grey shadow on a cream page looks like dirt. Gradients: gold sheen, teal depth, cream fade, hero glow. Opacity: hover wash 6%, pressed wash 12%, disabled 45%.

When to reach for which token

• Ordering a thing → --qd-primary. Acknowledging → --qd-accent only inside a dark band.
• Any text a customer must read → never --qd-accent; use --qd-accent-text.
• A section that needs separating from its neighbour → --qd-bg-subtle, never a border.
• A price → --qd-primary on light, --qd-accent on dark. Never gold on white.

6 — Visual direction

Gradients

Three only. Teal depth (teal 800 → 950, 160°) for the hero and the footer. Gold sheen (gold 300 → 500, 135°) for badge fills and hairlines, never for large fields — a big gold gradient reads as a placeholder. Cream fade (white → linen, 180°) to soften section joins without a line.

Elevation and texture

Cards rest on a 1px hairline plus shadow-sm; hover lifts 2px and moves to shadow-md. Product photography supplies the texture on this site — the Adinkra pattern below is for the wholesale band only, at 7% gold on teal, so it never competes with a product.

Photography

Shoot on white and on linen; the palette assumes a light field around the product and a dark field behind the story. Gold jewellery photographs warm, so keep the white balance neutral or the gold turns orange and fights Crown Gold. One product per frame, 4:5, longest edge 1600px. For the dark sections, shoot on deep teal rather than black: black crushes the shadow under a pendant, teal keeps the edge of the metal.

Icons

1.5px strokes in Ink 900 on light, Linen on dark. Never gold icons on white — at 2.2:1 they read as a ghost. Gold icons are permitted only inside a teal or black band, where they measure 4.6:1 and 9.7:1.

7 — What ships with this guide

File	What it contains
`tokens.css`	Primitives, semantic tokens for both modes, spacing, radius, shadows, gradients.
`components.css`	Buttons, links, fields, cards, nav, alerts — with every state.
`design-tokens.json`	Tokens Studio / Figma import: core ramps, light and dark semantic sets.
`preview.html`	Both modes side by side, with a toggle — the page to show the client.
`luxrio-child-1.7.0.zip`	The same CSS wired into the shop, loaded after the theme's own colours.

Where this stops

Colour is the one part of a brand system that can be verified by arithmetic, and this document does that. Typography, photography and layout are judgements, and the recommendations above are offered as such. Two things remain the client's decision: whether prices read teal or gold at full size, and whether the hero becomes teal. Both are one line to change, and both are easier to answer looking at preview.html than at a spec sheet.

The card to pin up

One page for anyone making a decision without the rest of this document in front of them.

Adinkra Teal	Crown Gold	Linen	Charcoal Ink
#0B4B4C	#C8AC77	#FAF8F5	#211F1C
Actions on light	Accent on dark	Backgrounds	Body text

Six rules

1. Prices and links are teal on light, gold on dark. Never gold on white (2.2:1).
2. Teal never appears inside a black section (2.1:1) — that is what the gold is for.
3. Gold lettering is Antique Gold #8F6B28, and only for a line, not a paragraph.
4. One primary button per view. A second primary is a decision taken from the customer.
5. Shadows are teal-tinted. Grey on cream looks like dust.
6. Every focusable thing gets a 2px ring — a colour shift alone is not a state.

Six things not to do

• Gold gradient across a large panel — reads as a placeholder image.
• Gold icons on white — they read as wounds in the page.
• Error shown by colour alone — roughly 1 man in 12 cannot separate the red from the green.
• A disabled button at 20% opacity — it vanishes instead of reading as unavailable.
• More than two type colours in one section.
• Maize yellow substitutes for Crown Gold. The gold is desaturated on purpose; a saturated yellow turns the shop into a market stall.

Adinkra Teal #0B4B4C · Crown Gold #C8AC77 · Antique Gold #8F6B28 · Linen #FAF8F5 · Charcoal Ink #211F1C · Queen Dor's Fashion House, Accra